

SKOAR! INVERSION™

Gravity gone bad

Sameer 'Psycho Mantis' Mitha
feedback@skoar.com

Inversion is a third-person cover-based shooter with a difference. It boasts of mechanics where gravity comes into play. Is gravity enough to distinguish this game from the crowd, or are you better off grounding your money in the tried and tested?

The story is pretty predictable. The city (Vanguard) is under threat from an alien race called the *Lutadore*. You don the role of a city cop named *Davis Russel* who has been taken captive by the *Lutadore*'s and his sole motive for escaping and taking out the bad guys is his daughter, who is missing. Along the journey, his partner assists him, so the game isn't a one-man army showdown.

The manner in which *Gears of War* has been copied is not even funny. From the way the character sprints from one point to another, hides behind cover and moves between cover – the resemblance is uncanny. Even the HUD that displays your weapons is almost the same as *Gears of War*.

The game has a very linear structure with cover-based shooting mechanics. It is the tried and tested mechanic of getting from point A to B with no room for exploration. The only roadblock comes in the form of obstructions that can be

taken care of with the "gravity gun". The game has some interesting zero-gravity moments where the ceiling becomes the floor or you are walking on the side of a building taking out the guys on the road. These moments are fun, give you a sense of disorientation, that the world has gone upside down, but will always leave you wishing there was more.

There is the occasional boss fight thrown into the mix, but it's more of a roadblock than an interesting twist in gameplay. The worst part is that the same boss is cycled throughout the game at various points adding to the repetitive nature of the game.

The graphics of the game aren't the best, but they aren't bad either. The character models look extremely stiff and this is reflected a lot more when they try to deliver an emotional expression. The city looks destroyed and very is reminiscent of *Gears of War*, which looks far better.

The same enemies are cycled more often than we like. But all is not lost. The way the glass shatters and the rubble falls when the gravity elements come into play is nicely done, only lacking in polish.

The audio in *inversion* is probably the weakest link. The voice acting is decent but the story progression kills it. The background score is pleasant but drowns out the on-screen gunfire, which is average. ★

Verdict

Inversion isn't a bad game. It's a copy of *Gears of War 3* with some new game-play mechanics but it lacks polish. The gravity elements are interesting but aren't explored to their fullest potential. The overall experience is average and lacks the bangs and adrenalin rush provided by a true AAA gaming title. If you like third-person action games then you can give this one a glance. It may not be worthy of a position in your 'elite games' collection but you can definitely try it out for a weekend. You won't be missing on much if you let this game slip under your radar though.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Saber Interactive
- » **Publisher:** Namco Bandai
- » **Platforms:** PS3 and XBOX 360: ₹2,499, PC: ₹1,299
- » **Tested on:** PS3

